(DRAFT 02-01-21)

PROPOSED POLICY REVISIONS

Information Item

Rationale: In 2014, OSPI established statewide math and science course equivalencies. School boards were required to provide an opportunity for high school students to earn at least one math or science course equivalency credit. In 2018, the Legislature expanded the subject areas for which OSPI could establish statewide course equivalencies to include English language arts, social studies, arts, world languages, health, technology, engineering, and physical education, in addition to mathematics and science. During the 2019 session, the Legislature passed HB 1424, Career and Technical Education ("CTE") Course Equivalencies. The requirement that school boards provide an opportunity for earning at least one math or science course equivalency credit was revised. Now, equivalency credit is not limited to the areas of math or science. Any CTE course for which OSPI has established a statewide equivalency will also fulfill the requirement. This requirement will end on September 1, 2021, and be replaced with the requirement that school boards offer academic credit for any statewide equivalency course it offers. School boards are also authorized to adopt local course equivalencies for CTE courses that are not on the list of courses approved by OSPI. The district policy is updated to reflect the new CTE course equivalency credit requirements.

Equivalency Credit for Career and Technical Education Courses

I. Career and Technical Education Courses

A. Until September 1, 2021, the district will provide high school students with the opportunity to access at least one (1) career and technical education course that is considered a statewide equivalency course as determined by the office of the superintendent of public instruction (OSPI) under RCW 28A.700.070.

B. On or after September 1, 2021, any statewide equivalency course offered by the district or accessed at a skill center will be offered for academic credit.

C. The district may also adopt local course equivalencies for career and technical education courses that are not on the list of course approved by the superintendent of public instruction under RCW 28A.700.070.

D. Each high school will adopt core academic course equivalencies for high school career and technical courses, provided that the career and technical course has been reviewed and approved for equivalency credit by a district team appointed by the superintendent or a designee.

E. The district team will include the curriculum director, the director of career and technical education, an instructor from the core academic subject area, any appropriate subject area resource coordinator(s), a school counselor, and a representative from the curriculum department will meet at least twice annually to evaluate equivalency requests or existing equivalencies which are recommended for evaluation. A Cascadia Technical Academy center representative will be present for all skill center courses evaluated.

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F. Career and technical courses approved for equivalency will be:

~~A.~~ 1. Aligned with the state's standards ~~academic learning requirements~~ and grade level expectations; and

~~B.~~ 2. Aligned with current industry standards, as evidenced in the curriculum frameworks. The local career and technical advisory committee will certify that courses meet industry standards.

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Legal References: RCW 28A.230.010
RCW 28A.230.097
RCW 28A.230.120
WAC 180-51
WAC 392-410

Adopted: May 8, 2018

Revised:

VPS